

FDE: Narrative + Behavioral

The code is the easy part of a final round. This decides it. Fill the **YOUR STORY** slots before the call.

30-SECOND OPENING

"Marketing teams need hundreds of on-brand variants per campaign, and by hand it's too slow and expensive.

I built a 6-step pipeline: a brief in YAML or JSON goes in, compliance-checked creatives come out.

Load the brief, gather or generate each image, render 3 aspect ratios, apply the brand overlay, organize outputs, check compliance.

Every step has a typed contract, every Claude call logs cost. It's a deliberate 2-3 hour POC, so I scoped out auth, queuing, and multi-tenancy on purpose.

Happy to go deep wherever you want."

Then stop talking. Let them steer.

BEHAVIORAL, FRAMED FOR FDE

Why a customer-facing FDE role? Why Adobe?

TESTING: do you actually want this, or is it a fallback.

ANCHOR: **YOUR REASON** + "I like owning the line from a messy customer requirement to a shipped answer. Adobe is where creative tooling and GenAI meet at enterprise scale."

Ambiguous or shifting requirements.

TESTING: do you scope, or boil the ocean.

ANCHOR: **YOUR STORY** + "The brief format wasn't given, so I defined the Zod contract myself and made it the source of truth. I picked the 80% path and documented the rest as deferred."

A technical tradeoff under time pressure.

TESTING: can you decide and defend, not just list options.

ANCHOR: pick one: polling over SSE (proxy buffered chunks) / deterministic compliance as the trusted gate, vision as advisory / failure isolation in compliance but not generation, a conscious scope cut.

Customer wants something the product can't do.

TESTING: do you push back well and offer a path.

ANCHOR: **YOUR STORY** + "I separate the need from the asked-for feature, confirm the need, then offer the closest supported path plus the cost of the bespoke one."

Disagreeing with a stakeholder.

TESTING: can you hold a position without being difficult.

ANCHOR: **YOUR STORY** + "I make it concrete and testable, then defer to data. If someone said 'just trust the vision check,' I'd show it has no seed and flips between runs."

TALK-TRACK REMINDERS

- Lead with the **customer problem**, not the tech.
- **Name your scope cuts before they do.** "I deferred X on purpose" = senior.
- Tradeoffs explicit: "I chose A over B because C, and here's when I'd revisit."
- Show observability: typed contracts, structured logs, cost ledger.
- Don't know? Say so, then say how you'd find out.

ASK THEM (PICK 2–3)

- "How much of an FDE engagement is greenfield building vs. integrating into the customer's existing Adobe stack?"
- "Where does the FDE handoff to core engineering happen, and what makes it go badly?"
- "What separates an FDE thriving here at one year from one who's struggling?"
- "How much of the role is GenAI solutioning vs. classic integration today, and where's that heading?"
- "What customer problem is your team fighting right now that you wish was solved?"